Retell: The Dog's Bell

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Student A retells steps 1–4, student B steps 5–8. Then swap the roles.

In the book
4000 Essential English Words 1, Unit 4, **"The Dog's Bell"**, page 30 (the story) · page 31 (questions 1–5).
Read it once (5 minutes), close the book, then retell with the map below.

#	Say	Words to use
1	Who is John, and what is the problem?	dog · bite · frequently · concern · village
2	How do the people in the village feel?	expect · avoid · none · spread
3	What does John try?	instruct · patient · calm · punish
4	Who visits John, and what is the idea?	friend · represent · issue · bell
5	Why does the dog like the bell?	content · song · people look at him
6	What happens one day?	stroll · other dogs · laugh · shake
7	What do the other dogs say?	avoid · popular · wrong reason
8	What is the lesson?	popular · positive

★ Tell it with the past continuous (add to your retelling)

1. What was John's dog doing when people saw him? (bite · walk down the street)
2. What were the villagers doing when they heard the bell? (work · stay away)
3. What was the dog thinking while he was strolling? (people · like · bell)

Three ways to retell

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What to do: Rounds 1 to 3 take about 15 minutes. Then the speaking questions.

1 Round 1: with the story map

Retell the whole story to your partner. The listener ticks the words they hear.

- [ ] appropriate
- [ ] avoid
- [ ] behave
- [ ] calm
- [ ] concern
- [ ] content
- [ ] expect
- [ ] frequently
- [ ] habit
- [ ] instruct
- [ ] issue
- [ ] none
- [ ] patient
- [ ] positive
- [ ] punish
- [ ] represent
- [ ] shake
- [ ] spread
- [ ] stroll
- [ ] village

2 Round 2: change the narrator

Retell it as **the dog**, as **John** or as **a villager**. Use "I": *"I was walking down the street when..."*

3 Round 3: change the ending

The dog hears the other dogs and ... What happens next? Invent a new ending (3–4 sentences).

4 Listener's check

- [ ] 5+ Unit 4 words
- [ ] past simple for events
- [ ] was / were + -ing for the scene
- [ ] a clear order

5 Warm-up: irregular verbs, set 3 (say the past)

begin	break	bring	catch
drink	drive	fall	feel
forget	hear		

began · broke · brought · caught · drank · drove · fell · felt · forgot · heard